

Five Steps to Financial Wellbeing

at play in our relationship with money than just the nuts and bolts of finance. If you are someone who struggles to feel deserving of money, whether that's because you feel you've failed to manage it in the past, or because you've never had enough, it's vital to overcome that in order to achieve a peaceful relationship with your finances, and to feel confident in asking to be paid your worth and comfortable with earning more. But that's not the universe – that's *you*. *You*, putting in the work to achieve financial wellbeing. *You* get to take the credit. It's important to remember that spending as though you are already wealthy, or leaving a fiver on the tube in the hope that more money will be returned to you by the universe, is not likely to help you to address the complexities of your relationship with money. The work that most people need to do around self-worth and money goes much deeper.

Money isn't the goal, it's the tool

'It's true that earning less [than the average annual income per capita] can dampen your sense of well-being, but earning more is not necessarily going to make you happier.'

Mo Gawdat, *Solve for Happy*¹¹

One of the key elements of financial wellbeing is not placing the burden of your happiness solely on your money. As we learned earlier in this step, that hedonic treadmill will keep